



AT THE Citadel Outlets in City of Commerce on Friday, shoppers search for bargains amid inflation worries.

Shoppers on a holiday hunt

Black Friday shoppers flocked to stores, hoping to get more bags for their buck as they grapple with inflation, tariffs and anxiety about the health of the economy.

The Citadel Outlets in City of Commerce was mobbed Friday morning with long waits for parking and winding lines in front of stores as consumers tried to grab good deals.

Camila Romero and her 13-year-old daughter spent hours in line trying to get the best possible deals on Ugg and Coach items on their wish lists.

"You come to the Citadel because it's outlets. And it's discounts on top of that," she said. "So

Black Friday deals draw people to stores across the Los Angeles area and U.S. amid economic anxiety

By CAROLINE PETROW-COHEN, CHRISTOPHER BUCHANAN AND GAVIN J. QUINTON

even when you're broke, you don't feel it."

Shoppers across the Los Angeles area plan to spend less this holiday season, data show. Although retailers tease their biggest deals and prepare for what they hope is robust demand, a Deloitte survey found that L.A.-area consumers plan to spend 14% less over the holidays compared with last year.

Nationally, shoppers are expected to spend 10% less than last year.

Consumers are pulling back on spending in response to economic uncertainty and rising prices, said Rebecca Lohrey, a partner at De-

Student rolls across nation are plunging amid ICE raids

School districts have tens of thousands fewer pupils, including foreign newcomers.

By HOWARD BLUME AND KATE PAYNE

Last school year, this Roybal Learning Center junior was doing well and making excellent grades. This year, as a senior, she's almost dropped out several times and has talked of leaving the U.S. and reuniting with her mother, who was deported over the summer to Guatemala.

So far, the girl has remained in school, says teacher Guadalupe Carrasco Cardona. But many students in similar situations have not.

Across the nation, immigration raids and border restrictions have led to a drop in K-12 enrollment that appears to number in at least the tens of thousands, affecting Los Angeles, San Diego, Miami and elsewhere, based on figures provided by school district officials.

The drop also reflects the

lack of non-U.S.-born students, or "newcomers," entering the nation's public school systems.

For students who had already been attending U.S. schools, the decline is an indicator of disrupted learning — and, in some school districts, financial shortfalls.

"These declines reflect a climate of fear and instability created by ongoing immigration crackdowns, which disrupt family stability, housing and mobility," said L.A. schools Supt. Alberto Carvalho.

"When families are afraid to be seen, or when they cannot afford to remain in their communities, they are less likely to enroll, reenroll, or stay in public schools."

At the Edward R. Roybal Learning Center just west of downtown L.A., there are at least 200 fewer students than anticipated, said Cardona, who teaches ethnic studies and serves as coordinator for a film and television magnet program. Before this year, she said, programs at the school had a waiting list.

"We're not too sure if [See Schools, A6]

Cartels' nemesis is Mexico's own 'Batman'

By PATRICK J. McDONNELL

MEXICO CITY — No floodlights illuminate the night sky when the citizens of Mexico's Gotham need a hand. No hot line summons this super-cop from a hidden redoubt.

But Mexico does indeed

have its own "Batman": Omar García Harfuch, security czar in the government of President Claudia Sheinbaum.

He acquired the Batman moniker during his days as Mexico City's crime-busting police chief under then-Mayor Sheinbaum. Like the stalwart Dark Knight, García Harfuch emits the vibe of a

vigilant protector who compensates for a lack of superpowers with more cerebral skills — a mix of intelligence, resolve and moxie.

In his current post (official title: secretary of Security and Citizen Protection), García Harfuch is inevitably dispatched to hot spots from the northern border to the southern hinterlands —

sites of assassinations, massacres, gang wars and other headline-grabbing incarnations of Mexican mayhem. The script never varies: He vows to snare the bad guys. Arrests follow.

Like his boss, Sheinbaum, the security chief disputes President Trump's assertions that Mexico is "run

Thai residents face obstacles to healthcare

Stigma, limited access and other issues present barriers for many needing help.

By PHI DO

Pranom was losing hope. She had been waiting more than two months to be accepted into a substance use program. A survivor of human trafficking, she was using meth to numb her depression, doing sex work to pay off her debts and caring for her adult son with special needs. The Times is not using her last name.



CARLIN STIEHL Los Angeles Times

PRANOM relied on meth to dull her senses for sex work. She needed to recover in order to help her son.

Her psychiatric social worker, Wanda Pathomrit, called a treatment center to start the intake process. But when Pranom arrived, they could not accept her because no one on staff could speak Thai.

"But you can hire an interpreter," Pathomrit told them. "She is ready. Do you know how hard it is to get someone who's ready to quit?"

Despite Southern California having the world's largest Thai population outside Thailand, those here face stigma, language barriers and limited resources when accessing mental

Trump seeks to expel millions of legal immigrants

By JOSH BOAK

WEST PALM BEACH, Fla. — President Trump says he wants to "permanently pause migration" from poorer nations and is promising to seek to expel millions of immigrants from the United States by revoking their legal status.

Trump is blaming immigrants for problems as diverse as crime and housing shortages as part of what he calls "social dysfunction" in

America and demanding "REVERSE MIGRATION."

His most severe social media post against immigration since returning to the Oval Office in January came after the shooting Wednesday of two National Guard members who were patrolling the streets of the nation's capital under his orders. One died and the other is in critical condition.

On Friday, his administration announced it is halting all asylum decisions. The director of U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services, Joseph Edlow, said in a post on the social platform X that this will be paused "until we can ensure that every alien is vetted and screened to the maximum degree possible."

Rahmanullah Lakanwal, a 29-year-old Afghan national who worked with the CIA during the Afghanistan war, is facing charges in this week's attack. The suspect came to the U.S. as part of a program after U.S. withdrawal from Afghanistan to resettle those who had helped American troops.

Lakanwal applied for asylum during the Biden administration, but his asylum was approved under the Trump administration, according to #AfghanEvac, a nonprofit that works with the U.S. government to resettle Afghans here.

Trump's threat to stop immigration would be a serious blow to a nation that has long defined itself as welcoming immigrants.

Since Wednesday's shooting near the White House, administration offi-

Pickleball turns Carmel-by-the-Sea into 'madhouse' of ringing thwacks

By HANNAH FRY

The constant *pop pop pop* of the plastic ball was simply too much to take.

Kimberly Edwards, who lives near the tennis-turned-pickleball courts at Forest Hill Park in Carmel-by-the-Sea, could hear the resonant sound everywhere she turned — outside in her garden, even through her bed-

room window.

"It is very annoying," she told the City Council last month. "And unless you live there, I know it's not a problem for you, but it's a problem for me."

After years of resident complaints, Carmel-by-the-Sea recently became the first California city to ban pickleball at public facilities. The sport, which blends elements of tennis, bad-

minton and ping-pong, has exploded in popularity over the last decade, with many cities building or retrofitting their public courts to accommodate crowds of paddle-packing enthusiasts.

But the sport's astonishing rise has created an unbearable racket for some nearby neighbors.

Pickleball players say there's a certain satisfaction



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

AFTER YEARS of contention, the city becomes the first in California to ban the sport at public facilities.

Murder charge in Guard shooting

Suspect in the D.C. attack faces new count after the death of one of the soldiers. **NATION, A4**

Snapchat in a critical moment

App nearing a billion monthly users but sees falling shares and still no profit. **BUSINESS, A10**

House inquiry on antisemitism

Berkeley's school district is one of three under congressional scrutiny. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Partly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 70/49. **B8**

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